Worksheet W5 · W-Seminar "Time"

Research methods

From your working thesis to the information you need – and nothing more.

1 My question – version 2

improve version 1 from W4

spark → question → **working thesis** → testable claim → thesis

Question: *How does the tempo of background music change how long a wait feels to teenagers?*

Working thesis: *Students who wait with fast music judge a three-minute wait as shorter than students who wait with slow music.*

Changed since W4 – and why: *sources: the tempo matters, not music as such – so: tempo, teenagers*

2 Five refinery questions

Questions your paper must answer so that your thesis can stand. Give each one a job, then check it: **O** = open (no yes/no, no either/or) · **N** = necessary (without it: a gap) · **A** = answerable (sources or own data).

job	my refinery question	O	N	A
1 Define	*How do psychologists define "perceived duration", and how does it differ from clock time?*	☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 2				
2 Explain	*Which models explain why the same duration can feel shorter or longer – and what role do attention and arousal play?*	☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 2				
3 Context	*In which everyday situations does waiting matter, and how do shops or hospitals try to make it feel shorter?*	☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 1				
4 Test	*How large is the difference between the fast-music and the slow-music group in my experiment, and how reliable is it?*	☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 3 + 4				
5 Evaluate	*To what extent can the results of one school experiment be generalised, and which other factors could explain them?*	☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 5 + 6				

3 From question to search string

for question *2*

	term	synonym	synonym
concept 1	*perceived duration*	*time perception*	*time estimation*
concept 2	*music*	*tempo*	*arousal*
concept 3	*waiting*	*waiting time*	*queue*

My search string: *("perceived duration" OR "time perception") AND (music OR tempo) AND waiting*

Operators AND · OR · NOT / - · "exact phrase" · ( ) · chrono* · site: · filetype:pdf · intitle:

4 Where I will search

☐ Google Scholar ☐ BASE / CORE / DOAJ ☐ library catalogue (OPAC) ☐ Destatis / Our World in Data
☐ Project Gutenberg / Internet Archive ☐ newspapers (context only) ☐ other: _____

Snowballing: backward = its works cited · forward = "Cited by"

One good source to snowball from: *a review on music and waiting – then "Cited by"*

builder + planner

5 My research matrix

Scan → skim → read closely. Note only what answers a question. Mark every note: **[Q]** quote · **[P]** paraphrase · **[!]** own thought – [Q] and [P] always with page.

source (author, year)	Q#	key point (page)	type
handbook chapter, 2014	*1*	*judging time while it passes vs. in memory (32)*	*[P]*
music study, 2016	*2, 4*	*fast music → arousal → shorter estimates (5)*	*[P]*
own idea	*4*	*same playlist length for both groups, same room*	*[!]*

6 Check one source: the five Ws

Source: *newspaper science page on a new study about music and waiting*

Who? author	*science journalist – not the researcher*
Where? publication	*national newspaper, not peer-reviewed*
What? evidence	*summarises a study and links it*
When? date	*2025 – current*
Why? purpose	*to inform – and to attract readers*

☐ lateral reading done Verdict: ☐ solid ☒ use with care ☐ avoid

7 Parking lot interesting, but not needed for my five questions

history of elevator music – maybe one sentence as a hook in the introduction